

World's biggest toy collection!

35,000 different toys made between 1850 and 1940 are up for auction at Sotheby's

Lego MMORPG

Check out Lego Universe, an MMORPG game at <http://bit.ly/ev8Yw5>

Feature



AR Drone with its hull shield

opers have created some really interesting iPhone controlled car prototypes, but these are not mass produced yet.

It's an artificial bug's life!

HEXBUGs could just scare some of you, but are kind of cute especially when they try to get back on their feet after flipping over. This is one of the main USP of the hottest selling model of the HEXBUG-Nano. This tiny little bug packs in a lot of technology in it and a great deal of research has gone into making these so much fun. HEXBUG has worked on 150 different types of variants for its legs alone before the final Nano came out. There are six dif-

ferent models of bugs available- Original, Inchworm, Crab, Ant, Nano and Spider. The Inchworm and Spider are remote controlled and feature a dual band control which means two bots can be controlled simultaneously. These bugs are light, sound and touch sensitive and react when they are exposed to each other. These things are pure fun to look at imagine how cool it would be to play with them. There are just too many video links for each one of their models so it's just better that you visit the web site <http://www.hexbug.com/> This year they won the Toy of the Year award.



HEX BUG Nano

LEGO Mindstorms NXT

The Mindstorms was first launched in 1998 and following its tremendous success the NXT was unveiled in the market in 2006. Lego Mindstorms works on NXT technology which basically is a Lego brick with a micro computer packed into it. The NXT brick serves as the main unit on to which various sensors can be ported. The coolest thing about the Mindstorms is that it gives the user freedom to build any form or shape of robot using the NXT brick as its base which can be programmed using the NXT-G language written specifically for it. The Mindstorms bots are light, touch and sound sensitive. The complete set comprises of 619 different elements like gears, tires, wheels, tracks and so on. The instruction manual would guide you into building four bots each with different movements and sense abilities, these four bots train the user in building a basic to an advanced bot.

Make your own Android driven car

Although still in development phase, this project is a good lead for any developer interested in creating a small car robot controlled via an Android phone. BluCar is a free app available on the Android Market which you can use as an interface between the car and your phone. Once you have downloaded the app, you need to have a separate Bluetooth module to communicate with your phone. This module can be placed on any car or robot lookalike hardware and it can perform basic functions like moving forward, backward and left to right. Watch an interesting video at <http://bit.ly/fyhBoG>. To download the app from Android market visit <http://bit.ly/gqgnvf>.

Get your hands on these toys!

We would like nothing better than to play with these toys all day long, emphatic geeks that we are, however its not that easy to score for these toys in India but we did the research and found out a few places where you can get your hands on these cool bots. The Lego Mindstorms NXT is available for approximately Rs. 25000 and would be available at leading toy stores in metros. You can order for the AR Drone from Amazon.com for around ₹14,000



AR Pursuit game screen : Targeting the enemy with your missile



AR Drone default screen view with thumb controls on left and right.



The Lego NXT brick

excluding shipping charges. The creepy crawly HEX BUG micro bots are shipped from ₹540 to ₹1,125 from their web site.

We want more!

So these were the toys of today we'd fancy ourselves playing but the way smart toys are developing they would get better and more intelligent. We'd like to see Transformer bots which transform on their own and fight each other while changing into robots. Guess there's a child in all of us somewhere. Send us your creative concepts on cool future toys. 